

3.2.3 Green Roofs and Walls

Objectives

- (a) To encourage the use and installation of green roofs and walls to increase building performance, thermal comfort, fauna habitat, localised air temperature and aesthetics of the urban environment.
- (b) To encourage green roofs and walls in commercial and mixed use zones.
- (c) To encourage green roofs and walls to be integrated into existing and new developments.
- (d) To ensure green roofs are non-trafficable areas which do not cause adverse visual or acoustic privacy impacts on neighbouring properties.

Controls

- (a) Council will determine if a green roof will be considered as landscaped area on a site-by-site basis.
- (b) Green roofs are not to be used as recreational areas.
- (c) The selection of plant species must give consideration to sun access, wind, views, overshadowing and other environmental conditions.
- (d) Utilise lightweight soil mixes that are porous, able to drain freely, and suitable for the selected plant species. Seek suitable professional advice regarding appropriate soil depths and types.
- (e) Visual impact:
 - (i) Where a green roof or wall affects views, careful consideration is to be taken to ensure the chosen species of plants will not interrupt or diminish views from adjacent properties.
 - (ii) Green roofs must be contained within the overall building height limit.
 - (iii) Green roofs or walls are not to detract from the heritage significance of a building or heritage conservation area.
- (f) Any access is to be for servicing the green roof only.
- (g) To discourage recreational use of the roof, a balustrade at the perimeter is not permitted.
- (h) The green roof is to have a minimum soil depth of 300mm for ground covers.
- (i) Demonstrate that adequate drainage and waterproofing is provided for the species and volumes of plants and soil.
- (j) Provide appropriate methods for capturing, storing and treating run off from landscapes on structures for reuse on the site.
- (k) Consideration should be given to the strength of a waterproofing membrane through the following method:
 - (i) Flood testing
 - (ii) Electrical field vector mapping (EFVM)
 - (iii) Destructive testing.
- (l) The overall design of the green roof should minimise wind uplift.
- (m) Sub-surface drip irrigators should be used to direct moisture to plant roots.
- (n) Irrigation should be provided from rainwater harvesting, treated grey water or treated black water.